

Section A: A short written translation exercise to test students' ability to transfer meaning from English into French effectively.

Section B: A French-language essay in response to one from a choice of seven questions, linked to the prescribed general topic areas, that invite either discursive or creative writing.

Section C: A research-based essay in French (240-270 words) to reward students for French-language research skills linked to an area of interest to the student that relates to the culture and/or society of a French-language country, countries or community. They have freedom to determine the content of their research (potentially in negotiation with their teacher) but it must relate to the four research-based essay topic areas for this unit.

All students for this unit will be assessed by Edexcel.

Students are not permitted to take any books, dictionaries or texts into the examination room.

B Specification overview

Summary of assessment requirements

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 1: Spoken Expression and Response in French	AS	8–10 minute assessment The assessment for this unit has two sections that total 50 marks. Section A This requires students to respond to four Edexcel-set questions on a stimulus related to the student's chosen general topic area. The teacher/examiner* will first ask two questions about the general content of the stimulus and will then follow on with two other questions that invite students to express their opinions on, or give reactions to, the stimulus. Section B The second part requires the teacher/examiner* to engage the student in a discussion that, although still relating to the same general topic area and its linked subtopics, moves away from the main focus of the stimulus. The test time should be divided equally, where appropriate, between Sections A and B. (Some students may need less than four minutes to respond fully to the stimulus-related questions.) Progression from Sections A to B should occur without any break in recording. Centres will need to record the full assessment of all students on either cassette or CD. All students for this unit will be assessed by Edexcel. *It is usual for teachers to conduct this assessment with their students during a timetabled assessment window in April/May, although Edexcel offers a visiting examiner facility for centres that have a minimum of ten AS and/or A2 students. For timetable and fee information, please consult the Edexcel website: www.edexcel.org.uk.	50 marks

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 2: Understanding and Written Response in French	AS	2 hour 30 minute paper The paper set for this unit has three sections. Section A (20 marks) Students will be required to listen to a range of authentic recorded French-language material and to retrieve and convey information given in the recording by responding to a range of French-language questions. Students will need to show understanding of both the general sense and specific details conveyed. The questions will elicit non-verbal responses and short answers in French. Students will have individual control of the recording and may stop, revisit and replay sections of the recording as required within the time allocated for this section (45 minutes maximum). They must make notes and answer questions within the first 45 minutes of this unit assessment and can move on to another section as soon as they are ready. Section B (20 marks) Students will be required to read authentic French-language printed materials and to retrieve and convey information by responding to a range of mainly French-language test types. The questions will elicit non-verbal responses, French-language answers and English answers that require a transfer of meaning from French. Section C (30 marks) Students will be required to write 200-220 words in the form of a letter, report or article in French based on a short printed French-language stimulus. Students must respond to four-six linked bullet points and demonstrate their ability to communicate accurately in French using correct grammar and syntax as detailed in <i>Appendix 6: Grammar lists</i>. Students will have individual control over the pace of this examination, including the listening element. However, for practical reasons, they must start the listening section first (Section A) and must complete this within the first 45 minutes. A CD recording will be provided for each student with the examination paper. Student access to equipment that permits individual listening (eg portable CD player with headphones) is required. All students for this unit will be assessed by Edexcel. Students must not have access to a dictionary or other reference materials during this examination.	70 marks

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 3: Understanding and Spoken Response in French	A2	11–13 minute assessment Students will first need to outline their chosen issue for about one minute, adopting a definite stance towards the issue. They should then defend and justify their opinions for up to four minutes. The teacher/examiner* will then initiate a spontaneous discussion in which a minimum of two further unpredictable areas of discussion will be covered. These issues may or may not relate to the chosen issue but will not require specialised factual knowledge or relate to French-language culture. This unit therefore assesses advanced-level understanding as well as speaking skills. Students will be required to take into the examination a brief written statement on an <i>Oral chosen issue form</i> and may refer to this in the test. More details are available in the <i>GCE oral training guide</i>, available on the Edexcel website (www.edexcel.org.uk). The chosen issue does not have to relate to any of the general topic areas for this specification. Centres will need to record the full assessment of all students on either cassette or CD. All students for this unit will be assessed by Edexcel. *It is usual for teachers to conduct this assessment with their students during a timetabled assessment window in April/May, although Edexcel offers a visiting examiner facility for centres that have a minimum of ten AS and/or A2 students. For timetable and fee information, please consult the Edexcel website: www.edexcel.org.uk.	50 marks

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 4: Research, Understanding and Written Response in French	A2	2 hour 30 minute paper The paper set for this unit has three sections. Section A (10 marks) A short written translation exercise to test students' ability to transfer meaning from English into French effectively. The English language stimulus will be about 80 words long. Section B (45 marks) A French-language essay in response to one from a choice of seven questions that invite either discursive or creative writing. The discursive essay requires students to write 240-270 words in French to reveal their ability to organise arguments and ideas and give a structured consideration of a general issue. The creative essay requires a different type of response (also of 240-270 words) based on an imaginative French-language text or a combination of text and visual(s). Both discursive and creative questions will link to the prescribed seven topic areas. Section C (45 marks) A research-based essay in French (240-270 words) rewards students for French-language research skills linked to an area of interest to the student. This must relate to the culture and/or society of a French-language country, countries or community. Students will need to draw on their knowledge and understanding of this. They will have freedom to determine the content of their research (potentially in negotiation with their teacher) but it must relate to one of the following areas of research: - a Geographical area - b Historical study - c Aspects of modern society - d Literature and the arts (eg text, play or film). A question will be set for each of these four areas of research. All students for this unit will be assessed by Edexcel. Students are not permitted to take any books, dictionaries or texts into the examination room.	100 marks

Assessment objectives and weightings

		% in AS	% in A2	% in GCE
AO1	Understand and respond, in speech and writing, to spoken language.	40%	25%	32.5%
AO2	Understand and respond, in speech and writing, to written language.	35%	50%	42.5%
AO3	Show knowledge of and apply accurately the grammar and syntax prescribed in the specification.	25%	25%	25%
TOTAL		100%	100%	100%

Relationship of assessment objectives to units

Unit number	Assessment objective			
	AO1	AO2	AO3	Total for AO1, AO2 and AO3
Unit 1	10%	—	5%	15%
Unit 2	10%	17.5%	7.5%	35%
Unit 3	12.5%	2.5%	2.5%	17.5%
Unit 4	—	22.5%	10%	32.5%
Total for Advanced GCE	32.5%	42.5%	25%	100%

Qualification summary

Subject criteria

The General Certificate of Education is part of the Level 3 provision. This specification is based on the Advanced Subsidiary GCE and Advanced GCE subject criteria for modern foreign languages, which are prescribed by the regulatory authorities and are mandatory for all awarding bodies.

The Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in French have been designed in response to the subject criteria which are intended to:

- help ensure consistent and comparable standards in the same subject across the awarding bodies
- define the relationship between the Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE level specifications, with the Advanced Subsidiary as a subset of the Advanced GCE level
- ensure that the rigour of the Advanced GCE is maintained
- help higher education institutions and employers know what has been studied and assessed.

Aims

The Edexcel Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in French aims to encourage students to:

- develop an interest in, and enthusiasm for, language learning
- develop understanding of the language in a variety of contexts and genres
- communicate confidently, clearly and effectively in the language for a range of purposes
- develop awareness and understanding of the contemporary society, cultural background and heritage of countries or communities where the language is spoken
- consider their study of the language in a broader context.

The Edexcel Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in French enables students to:

- derive enjoyment and benefit from language learning
- acquire knowledge, skills and understanding for practical use, further study and/or employment

AS/A2 knowledge and understanding

The Advanced Subsidiary specification requires students to:

- listen and respond to a variety of spoken* French-language sources, including authentic sources
- read and respond to a variety of French-language written texts, including authentic sources, covering different contexts, registers, styles and genres
- adapt their spoken and written French language appropriately for different situations and purposes
- use the French language accurately to express facts and ideas, and to present explanations, opinions and information in both speech and writing
- understand and apply the grammatical system and a range of structures of the French language as detailed in *Appendix 6: Grammar lists*
- transfer meaning from French into English and/or vice versa.

In addition, the Advanced GCE specification requires students to:

- use the French language in speech and in writing to present viewpoints, develop arguments, analyse and evaluate
- understand and apply the grammatical system and a range of structures in French as detailed in *Appendix 6: Grammar lists*
- study aspects of the contemporary society, cultural background and heritage of one or more of the French-language countries or communities
- transfer meaning from English into French and/or vice versa. If one skill is not assessed at Advanced Subsidiary level it must be assessed at A2 level.

*Spoken and written sources must include material that relates to the contemporary society, cultural background and heritage of one or more of the countries or communities where the language is spoken.

AS/A2 skills

The knowledge and understanding requirements of this Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE specification are inextricably linked to the four language skills of **speaking, listening, reading** and **writing** in French, in line with the requirements of the subject criteria.